

ENCOUNTERS

each side. If this is done, character's Dexterity scores (see page B7) are used to adjust the initiative die rolls. The DM may wish to adjust the monsters' initiative rolls for monsters which are very fast.

PARTY ACTIONS: The first decision a party must make in an encounter is whether to fight, talk, run, or wait to see what the monster will do.

If the party chooses to **fight**, combat will begin; the DM should use the **Combat Sequence** (page B24) to handle fights.

If the party chooses to **talk** (and if the monster will listen), the DM plays the part of the monster. The players can ask questions, make bold statements, and otherwise react to the creature. The encounter may then become peaceful (agreement!), hurried (as the monster or party runs away), or violent (if the talks lead to combat).

If the party chooses to **run away**, the monster might not follow, in which case the encounter is over. If the monster decides to chase them, the players must try to outrun it or distract it so that they may escape (see **Evasion**, page B24).

If the party chooses to **wait** to see what the monster will do, the DM must decide the monster's reactions.

MONSTER ACTIONS: Some monsters always act in the same way (such as zombies, who always attack). However, the reactions of most monsters are not always the same. The DM can always choose the monster's reactions to fit the dungeon, but if he decides not to do this, a DM may use the reaction table below to determine the monster's reactions (roll 2d6).

Monster Reactions

Dice Roll	Reaction
2	Immediate Attack
3-5	Hostile, possible attack
6-8	Uncertain, monster confused
9-11	No attack, monster leaves or considers offers
12	Enthusiastic friendship

ENCOUNTER MOVEMENT: Movement during encounters is usually very quick. This movement speed cannot be kept up for more than 60 rounds. To find the movement rate of creatures during a round, divide the base movement rate by 3 (for example, a character who moves at 60'/turn would move at 20'/round). For the DM's convenience, the movement rate (per round) of monsters has been calculated and included in the monster descriptions, and is given in parentheses () after the base movement rate. The movement rate per round of a character is given in the **Character Movement** table (page B19).

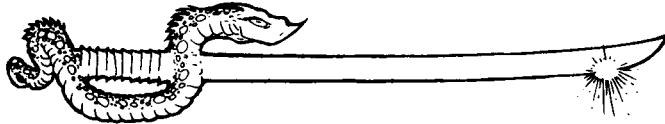
RUNNING: Running characters may move at up to three times their normal movement rate (per round). No mapping is allowed while running. Characters may only run for half of a turn (30 rounds), and must then rest for three complete turns. If forced to fight before they are fully rested, the characters will fight with a -2 penalty on their "to hit" and damage rolls, and their opponents will gain a bonus of +2 on their "to hit" rolls. These penalties will remain until the characters have fully rested. Any successful hit by a character will still do at least 1 point of damage, whatever the adjustments.

EVASION: Sometimes one side wishes to evade (avoid) an encounter. If the evading side has a faster movement rate than the other and combat has not yet begun, evasion is automatic as long as the evading side is not forced to stop. If monsters wish to evade and are slower, the characters must decide among themselves whether or not to chase them. If characters wish to evade and are slower than the monsters, the DM must decide what the monsters

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will do. Use the **Monster Reactions** table to find the actions of the monsters. A low score means that the monsters will pursue, and a high score means that the monsters will let the party escape.

PURSUIT: If either side wants to pursue the other, time is counted in **rounds**, and both sides are **RUNNING** (see above). Monsters will chase evading characters only as long as the characters are in sight. Evading characters may be able to slow this pursuit by dropping things. Unintelligent monsters will stop to eat food $\frac{1}{2}$ the time (a result of 1-3 on 1d6). Intelligent monsters will stop to pick up treasure $\frac{1}{2}$ of the time. Burning oil will usually (but not always) slow or stop monsters pursuing the characters.



COMBAT

Combat occurs when characters fight monsters or other characters. In combat, opponents are referred to as different "sides". It is possible to have several groups fighting each other and therefore have more than 2 sides. Combat includes throwing or shooting weapons, such as spears and bows, casting spells and meleeing or fighting with handheld weapons such as swords. The following sequence is used to resolve combat.

Combat Sequence

- A. Each side rolls for initiative (1d6).
- B. The side that wins the initiative acts first (if simultaneous all actions are performed by each side at the same time):
 1. Morale checks, if needed (page B27).
 2. Movement per round, meleed opponents may only move defensively (spell casters may not move and cast spells).
 3. Missile fire combat:
 - a. choose targets
 - b. roll 1d20 to hit; adjust result by Dexterity adjustment, range, cover, and magic
 - c. DM rolls damage
 4. Magic spells (roll saving throws, as needed: 1d20).
 5. Melee or hand-to-hand combat:
 - a. choose (or be attacked by) opponents
 - b. roll 1d20 to hit; adjust result by Strength adjustment and magic weapons
 - c. DM rolls damage; adjust result by Strength adjustment and magic weapons
- C. The side with the next highest initiative acts second, and so on using the order given above, until all sides have completed melee.
- D. The DM handles any surrenders, retreats, etc. as they occur.

Repeat steps A through D as many times as necessary to finish the melee. Once the game turn ends; see the **Order of Events in One Game Turn** to continue.

Defensive Movement

Movement in combat is handled per round, as explained before. However, only the following special forms of movement are possible once opponents are engaged in melee. These types of defensive movement may be used by both characters and monsters. A character who wants to use one of these forms must say so before the initiative roll for the round. Meleed creatures who slay all their opponents are no longer meleed.